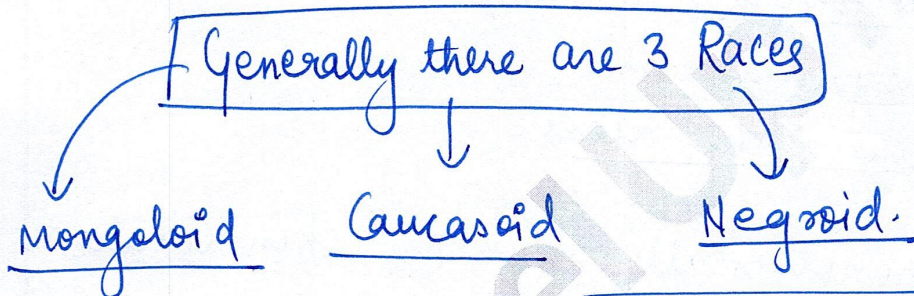


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anything in this Area)

- Q.6) (a) "The idea of race is both scientifically obsolete and politically dangerous." Examine this statement using evidence from genetic studies, anthropological debates, and historical misuse racial classification. (20 Marks)

Race is the subclassification of the human population based on certain physical characteristics.



But, due to basis on folk taxonomy and cultural variation, these categories of races vary, some say there are 8 races, 84 races, etc.

Idea of Race is Scientifically obsolete and Politically dangerous because:-

Evidences from Genetic studies :-

- ① As per the Human Genome project

all the humans are genetically 99.9% identical.

② 0.1% of differences is further divided into

- 50% is due to sexual differences.
- 90% is Junk DNA

The left over is insignificant in creating the races.

③ Phenotypically → The skin colour is having more variation within the race, rather than among the race.

④ The ABO blood group & Rh is universally present. We cannot, associated "B" to Africans or blacks & "A, O" to Europeans.

⑤ Evolutionary significance like isolation had not been much to create races.

Evidence from Anthropological debate

- ① Franz Boas, who propounded Historical particularism and cultural relativism told that :-
 - ↳ every culture has its own unique history.
 - ↳ they should be studied contextually.
 - ↳ Interplay of Individual psyche, environment and specific cultural history
- ② RC Lewontin also said that Humans are genetically similar.
- ③ Its misuse was seen by the preconceived notions of Mead in studying Samoans girls.
- ④ Brown also did verandah fieldwork among the Andamanese.

Evidence from Historical Misuse.

- ① Samuel Wright gave the disease for negritos like Drapetomania
 ↳ they should be beaten with belt when not working
 ↳ they should not be allowed to have free & open air.
- ② Colonial ^{powers} exploited colonies for labour, slave, raw materials and market for their goods.
- ③ American Breeders Society was developed to promote Eugenics
- ④ Various laws like → Red Act, Criminal tribes Act developed to classify people.

But, all of these evidences are the proof that it was cultural hegemony to promote western interests.